

Interview Report by Piter Garcia Computer & Electrical Engineering Department

Vincent Di Matteo is the person that is being interviewed and he is a supervisor in the engineering department at Data Device Corporation. He is in charge of many projects that contribute to the development of the aerospace and military technology as well as other private and prestigious companies. I chose him because of his knowledge and position in the engineering field, and because I believe his experience could guide me through in my field to become a successful engineer. All questions are based on the following steps about the job, job writing, and social media and they were asked in the following order.

1) About the Job

Personal Career Choices:

Q - What's the most important priority to you as an engineer?

A - As project Engineer, design product that meets the design/cost goals and on schedule are the most important priorities taken into account for your team to succeed.

Q - Why?

A - Because we as a company must be able to ultimately sell products to stay ahead of the competition.

Q - How have your career goals changed over time?

A - My career goals have become more managerial in nature.

Career Duties:

Q - What is the most difficult task you have undertaken as an engineer?

A - Design under tight schedule has been the most difficult task for me, as an engineer, to undertake at work.

Q - Tell me about the projects you mostly work on?

A - The projects I mostly work on are Designing Power controllers, proprietary projects.

Priorities and Success Tips:

Q - What are some of the reasons for your success?

A - To embrace change is one of the reason to my success.

Q - How did you move up within the company?

A - I started as a technician and I have been moving up within the company by embracing changes in our design projects and company as well.

Q - What does failure mean to you?

A - Failure to me means a lesson learned, and also a way to improve.

Professional Advices:

Q - What personal characteristics do you feel are necessary to be a successful engineer?

A - The characteristics that are necessary to be a successful engineer are attention to details, analytical, and good problem solving.

2) About the writing process

Q - What sorts of documents do you write?

A - Design Specs, procedures,, and verification reports.

Q - Who are the different audiences that you write for?

A - The audiences I mostly write to are customers, vendors and co-workers.

Q - What adjustments do you make to your message (or style) for each type of audience?

A - I make adjustments to customers and vendor; taking into account that I must be careful of sharing proprietary information.

Q - Describe the most significant written technical report or presentation that you had to complete.

A - One of the most significant technical report I wrote was a power design review presentation to customers.

Q - Tell me about the most challenging technical proposal you have ever written.

A - This type of information cannot be disclose due to company policy. However, the most challenging technical proposals are written for military and aerospace government agencies who must be impressed by the product in order for them to proceed with the project.

3) Social Media

Q - How do you feel about social media?

A - When it comes to work and getting the job done social media is not appealing to me. Nevertheless, I do believe that can contribute in big business-wise.

Q - Have you ever used social media (LinkedIn, blog, twitter, simply hired, glass door, etc) to find a job or examine a candidate for a job?

A - No, I personally have not used any kind of social media to hire or examine any candidate for a position at this company. When I interview somebody for a position, my job is to test the knowledge, experience and candidate's development throughout the interview.

Q - If so, can you describe that experience?

A - I have not had any kind of experience with social media.

Q - What value do you (or does your company) place on a job candidate's web presence (i.e. what shows up when you Google his or her name)?

A - I am not sure how human resource handles this since they are in charge of reviewing candidates web presences for personal interviews.

Q - What rules does your company have regarding the use of social media sites at work or relating to work if any?

A - As per company policy, social media sites at work are restricted use. It is fine outside of work and not allowed to speak on behalf of the company unless instructed. On the other hand, the use of LinkedIn is not restricted if it is work related or instructed by our company.

Q - Do those rules/guidelines (or lack thereof) make sense to you?

A - Yes, all rules established by Data Device Corporation make absolute sense due to the privacy and ownership of our engineers and business partners, as well as other reasons government related that cannot be disclosed.

Q - Do you have any stories you'd like to share regarding social media and your workplace?

A - No, I really have not put to much emphasis into social media at work. However, I do realize that it is becoming a big issue job-wise for prestigious companies such as Data Device Corporation. I would definitely advice you to keep yourself in track with social media outside your work area.

The main purpose of my interview was to address the above steps that will help me throughout the process of obtaining a position in a result oriented environment to channel my career pursuits.

According to the information gathered on February 28th ,2012 from the supervisor of the engineering department at Data Device Corporation, I have come to the following conclusion. To succeed in your field, whether you are an engineer or not, all you need is to embrace change, pay attention to details and learn from your failures.

From my point of view, the engineer Vincent Di Matteo addressed most of my perspectives as far as how to succeed in the engineering field. Through him I confirmed that faith, hardworking, and education can get you anywhere in life. On the other hand, the writing process at his company is treated as a bible. Nevertheless, he outlined some important points such as write and verify delicately any material taking into account the public you are writing to. Moreover, I expected Vincent to be more involved with the social media. However, he made me realized that social medias can only get you at the door, not the job. The way you handle yourself during an interview determines your position in a company.